

who upgrade their phone annually. That's around \$15,000 per customer those companies miss out on over thirty years. We're usually so focused on wanting to make big individual changes that we forget how powerful small collective changes are in the long-term. And when more people adopt these small changes, the marketing narrative shifts away from "newphoria" to a demand for higher quality and sustainability, not just in technology but across the board. Only when the money leaves do companies have an incentive to go find it.

In business, money is the only thing that talks. We know individuals with the most money have the loudest voice, but collectively we can speak just as loud. We saw this firsthand after several price hikes in 2023 led to a slowdown in sales and ultimately forced companies like Target, Pepsi,¹⁴ and Walmart¹⁵ to lower prices on their products. Restraint from consumers shifted the practices of large corporations. And while most companies won't lower their prices, money talks. And the more intentionally we spend our money, the louder we say what we will and will not tolerate.

Beyond the Money

Values-based spending will require shifting your lifestyle in ways you hadn't expected, toward the things you love. Whether it's more time with family made possible by simplifying or finding a new hobby as the result of your curiosity practices, or changes you make in your housing and transportation purchases that give room for a great vacation or even debt freedom! Whatever it is you love, putting your resources toward that will be worth it, but it won't come without discomfort. Your habits will change, relationships will change, schedules and routines will change. There will be a lot of friction in the process of altering your direction. Embrace it. Value it.

Last year we recorded an episode with Nicole Johnsey Burke of Gardenary Co. about growing a garden with whatever space you have. I (Jen) was not super-interested in the episode at first because I had no desire to garden. Jill is the gardener. I do not have a natural green thumb, nor do I have the desire to maintain a garden when I can buy my produce so easily and affordably from the grocery store. Before we started recording, I told her "This one's for Jill, I don't garden, I cannot keep anything green alive."